

State of the Web 2020–2025

Tracking Page Weight, Protocols & Security at Scale

HTTP Archive Trends

Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

Crawl Sample Size Tripled

From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020

- **Dramatic Growth:** A sharp jump in URL coverage occurred around mid-2022.
- **Current Plateau:** The sample size has stabilized near 16M desktop and 12.5M mobile URLs.
- **Significance:** The massive scale of tracking guarantees high confidence in global web architectural trends.



Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily

Desktop approaching ~2,000 KB per page

- Desktop median climbed from ~1,600 KB to ~2,000 KB.
- Mobile tracks slightly lower but mirrors the ~25% upward trend over five years.
- **The Long Tail:** The 75th-percentile desktop page now exceeds 4,000 KB.

Total Kilobytes (Desktop Median)

~2,000 KB ▲ 25%



76 Requests/Page While TCP Connections Drop

Network multiplexing efficiency outpaces standard request volume growth

Desktop Requests

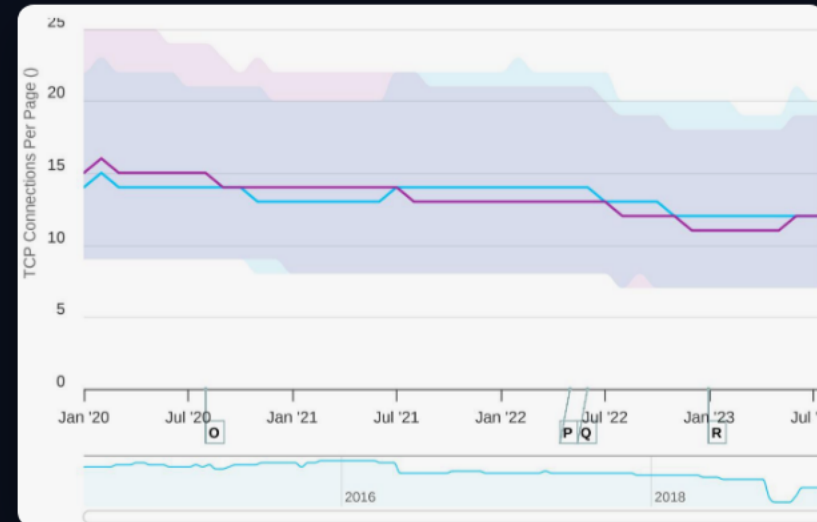
76

▲ 2.7% since 2020 (Mobile requests at 71)

TCP Connections (Median)

12.0

▼ 14.3% since 2020 (Down from ~15 connections)



Encryption Is Now the Default

Plaintext HTTP is effectively extinct on the modern web

99.2%+

HTTPS Requests

Up ~20 percentage points from ~80% in early 2020.

Mobile tracking is virtually identical at 99.1%.

Protocol Shifts: HTTP/3 Support Surges

HTTP/2 holds flat while HTTP/3 rapidly absorbs new protocol adoption

HTTP/2 Requests

58.6%

Relatively flat growth on Desktop.
It absorbs legacy HTTP/1.1 traffic while losing cutting-edge share to HTTP/3.

HTTP/3 Support

38.7%

Exploded from near-zero in 2020.
*Note: Metric represents support capability, as fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2.

Font-Display Reaches 42% on Mobile

Mitigating the Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT)

- **Mobile Adoption:** 42.5% (Up 61.0% since 2020)
- **Desktop Adoption:** 40.1% (Up 14.9% since 2020)
- **The UX Gap:** Despite growth, more than half of pages globally still risk showing invisible text during web font loading.

Mobile Growth

+61%

Significant relative improvement, yet massive room for industry-wide optimization remains.

Key Takeaways

Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

- **Weight Growth:** Page weight continues to grow (~25%) driven by richer media and JS.
- **Security Standard:** HTTPS is effectively universal at 99%+.
- **Protocol Shift:** HTTP/3 support is the fastest-growing metric, approaching 40%.
- **Network Efficiency:** TCP connections are declining (down 15-27%) thanks to multiplexing, despite slight rises in total requests.
- **UX Opportunity:** Font-display adoption still has significant room to grow to prevent invisible text.

Call to Action: Benchmark your sites against these baselines.